

MicroPulse

Today — Coach Guide

Your morning command-centre — the single screen that shapes today's session

FOR LITE CATAPULT TEAMS

1. Overview — what is the Today page?

Today is the first thing you see when you open the MicroPulse coach dashboard. It is the morning command-centre — the single screen that combines every signal MicroPulse has computed overnight, presented in a top-down briefing that walks you through team-state, individual-player decisions, and the recommended day-type. By the time you reach the bottom of the page you should know exactly who plays full, who is on a reduced session, and who is in recovery.

The page structure follows the **Gabbett 2020 Communicate step** — the published framework for translating monitoring data into the daily team brief. The top of the page is the 30-second readout; the deeper cards below let you drill into the why for any individual player.

Lite tier verdict

The Today tab is the centrepiece of MicroPulse for a Lite club — almost every card on it works at FULL fidelity because it's built on RPE, wellness, and total distance / HSR (universal Catapult metrics). The top-tab bar at the very top of the page has FOUR primary tabs (Today, Squad, Load, GPS) — but on Lite, Today is the only one that is unlocked. The other three (Squad, Load, GPS) require a Pro plan and show an UpgradeWall.

Where it sits in MicroPulse

- Page: /coach (the root coach URL — Today is the default tab).
- Visible to all Catapult plans, but on Lite it IS the dashboard — the other primary tabs are locked.
- Updated continuously throughout the day as players check in, RPE entries arrive, and Catapult sessions sync.

2. The top-tab bar — what you can and can't see on Lite

The very top of the dashboard has a strip of primary tabs. On Lite, only the first one (Today) is unlocked. The others show a lock icon and open an UpgradeWall when clicked.

Tab	What it would show	Lite tier
Today	Morning command-centre — daily briefing, team state, per-player decisions.	UNLOCKED — full access
Squad	Squad overview — every player's compliance, wellness, decision in a sortable table.	Locked — Pro required
Load	Internal-load monitoring (Daily Internal Load, Internal ACWR, Player Historical Snapshot, Session RPE Monitoring).	Locked — Pro required

Tab	What it would show	Lite tier
GPS	Manual GPS entry + raw daily numbers tab.	Locked — Pro required

Where the load monitoring lives on Lite

Load monitoring is NOT lost on Lite — it just lives on dedicated pages in the sidebar instead of in the top-tab bar. Use Load Intelligence (/coach/load-intelligence), Quadrant View (/coach/quadrant), HSR Intelligence (/coach/hsr-intelligence) and the standalone cards under Monitoring. Each of those has its own coach guide.

3. Cards on the Today tab — what you'll see

Top-to-bottom, the Today tab is composed of these cards. Read them in order — they're laid out as a briefing flow.

Card	What it shows	Lite tier
Onboarding Checklist	5-item setup checklist (players, check-ins, GPS, decisions, sport). Hides itself once setup is complete.	FULL
Daily Briefing Card	Gabbett 2020 Communicate step — bullet-pointed team and per-player narrative.	FULL
Today Command Centre	Sync buttons, PDF report buttons, team-status tiles, intelligence row, coach recommendation pill.	Mostly FULL
Team Indoor Briefing	Indoor-mode team-level executive summary. Only renders for indoor teams.	Only relevant for indoor sports
Decision Summary Card	Per-player today decision. The biggest card — one row per player with verdict, drivers, load signals, and modal drilldown.	Mostly FULL
Readiness × Load Quadrant	Mini 2 × 2 quadrant chart at-a-glance: who is over-loaded / under-loaded / fresh / hidden risk.	FULL

Lite-tier headline

Five of the six cards on this page work at FULL or near-full fidelity on Lite. The two cards labelled "Mostly FULL" have a few elements that depend on Pro-tier B2-3 efforts — those specific elements show "—" on Lite, but the rest of each card works completely. We'll call out exactly which fields those are below.

4. Card 1 — Onboarding Checklist

Shown only for new clubs in their first weeks. Five items appear as ticks once you complete them; the whole card auto-hides once the checklist is done.

Item	Done when...
Players added	≥1 active player on the roster.

Item	Done when...
Check-ins flowing	≥1 player has submitted a wellness check-in.
GPS data flowing	≥1 player has Catapult / GPS data in the system.
Decisions generated	≥1 player has a training_action (the engine has run).
Sport set	Team sport (football / basketball / etc.) is configured in Settings.

Lite tier

Works fully — the checklist applies to all tiers and uses no tier-restricted data.

5. Card 2 — Daily Briefing Card

The Daily Briefing is your morning narrative — short bulleted text that combines team-state, today's notable players, and the next-day forecast. Built as the operational implementation of Gabbett's 2020 Communicate step.

What it covers

- Team-state summary — number of players in Full / Reduced / Recovery.
- Notable individuals — players whose verdict has changed today, who are in red zones, or who have flagged drivers.
- Driver chips — short tags like "sleep 2/5", "soreness 2/5", or "HSR ACWR 1.6" that flag the specific signal.
- Counterfactuals — "this player would be GREEN if they slept 8h instead of 5h" — pulls the explanatory framework from the Decision Engine.
- Day-type forecast — based on today's verdict + recent trend, predicts tomorrow's likely decision.
- Compact / Detailed toggle — switch between a 5-line team summary and the full per-player narrative.

Lite tier

Works fully. Built on RPE, wellness, and total distance — all available on Lite. Counterfactuals and forecasts apply equally on Lite as on Pro because they use the same Decision Engine logic.

6. Card 3 — Today Command Centre

The biggest visual block on the page. Combines team-state tiles, intelligence metrics, and the headline coach recommendation — your one-glance "is the team OK today?" read.

Header row — buttons

- Sync Catapult button — pull today's GPS data from Catapult on demand. (StatSport teams see Sync StatSport instead.) Works on all tiers.
- Readiness Risk PDF — generate a one-page PDF report showing today's risk for each player. Works on all tiers.
- Post-Training PDF — generate a one-page PDF report showing post-training load and recovery recommendations. Works on all tiers.

Status tiles — the team-state strip

Tile	What it shows	Lite tier
Full	Number of players cleared for full availability today.	FULL
Reduced	Number of players on a modified session.	FULL
Recovery	Number of players on protected recovery.	FULL
Dominant fatigue	Most common fatigue type across the squad (autonomic / neuromuscular / general).	Reduced — needs RHR / HRV
Neural load	Current team neural state (NEUTRAL / ELEVATED / SUPPRESSED).	Reduced — needs neuromuscular inputs
Next-day risk	Forecast risk band for tomorrow.	FULL

Compact intelligence row

Tile	What it shows	Lite tier
Volatility	Percentage of squad classified as volatile in the last 14 days.	Works (RPE-based)
Avg risk	Team-average performance-intelligence risk score.	Reduced fidelity on Lite
Protected	Players currently flagged as protected by coach rules / admin config.	Works
Baseline	Baseline maturity badge — how mature the personal-baseline data is for the team.	Works

Coach recommendation pill

The colour-coded pill at the bottom of the Command Centre — combines the day-state diagnostic with the team-level external-load summary. This is the headline takeaway: "Train as planned", "Reduce intensity", "Recovery focus", etc. Always works on Lite.

What the Lite Command Centre is missing

The Command Centre's "Dominant fatigue" and "Neural load" tiles use the neural-load classification engine, which is most precise when fed RHR / HRV / neuromuscular data (jump tests, ForceFrame). On Lite without those integrations the tiles still show a value, but it's a coarser estimate built on RPE drift + wellness alone. Treat them as directional, not surgical.

7. Card 4 — Team Indoor Briefing

Only renders for teams whose training mode is auto-detected as indoor (basketball, handball, futsal, indoor mode override). For outdoor football clubs this card does not appear.

If your team is indoor, the card shows the team-level executive summary mirrored from the Indoor Load page — composite indoor load score per player, indoor ACWR, McBurnie indoor flag, sessions in the

last 7 days, and current injury status. **On Lite** (which most football clubs use), this card simply doesn't render — the page works fine without it.

8. Card 5 — Decision Summary Card

The biggest card on the page. One row per player. Each row shows: today's verdict (Full / Reduced / Recovery / Watch), the wellness drivers, yesterday's GPS load, the recommended action, and an info button that opens a modal with the full explanation.

What every row shows

- Player name + position.
- Today's verdict pill — colour-coded Full / Reduced / Recovery / Watch.
- Wellness driver chips — "sleep 2/5", "soreness 2/5", "mood 2/5" — the specific check-in fields that triggered a flag.
- Yesterday's GPS load summary — total distance, HSR, sprint distance, NBS.
- Load-signals block — NBS, composite score, fatigue type, decel burden, A:D ratio, HID%, residual decel.
- Active injury status — overrides the load verdict when present.
- "Why" info button — opens a modal with the full Decision Engine explanation, counterfactuals, and an Ask Claude Q&A panel (ELITE only).

Lite tier — what works

Element	Lite status	Why
Verdict pill	FULL	Built on RPE + wellness + readiness — universal inputs.
Wellness driver chips	FULL	Read directly from check-in entries.
Yesterday's GPS load	FULL	Total distance, HSR, sprint distance — all Lite metrics.
NBS (load-signals block)	Works	Computed from total distance + player load — Lite metrics.
Composite score	Works	Built on Lite-tier inputs.
Fatigue type	Works	Driven by RPE + wellness — universal.
Decel burden	—	Requires B2-3 efforts (Pro / Premium parameter). Will show "—".
A:D Coupling	—	Requires B2-3 acceleration AND deceleration. Will show "—".
HID%	Works	Computed from HSR vs total distance — Lite metrics.
Residual decel (3-day)	—	Built on decel burden, so unavailable.
Active injury status	FULL	Read from injury log — universal.
Why modal explanation	FULL	Decision Engine reasoning works on every tier.

Element	Lite status	Why
Ask Claude Q&A panel	Locked — ELITE only	AI Q&A is gated behind Elite tier.

On Lite the card is fully usable — the three "—" cells (decel burden, A:D coupling, residual decel) sit alongside everything else that works. Coaches who want decel-mechanism injury insight on Lite use **HSR Intelligence** (a separate top-tab page) which gives the Lite-equivalent injury monitor (Malone 2017 hamstring focus instead of McBurnie 2022 ACL/quad focus).

9. Card 6 — Readiness × Load Quadrant

A mini 2 × 2 chart at the bottom of the Today tab. Plots readiness score (Y-axis) vs load (X-axis) with the team median as the cross-hair, splitting the squad into four groups.

Quadrant	What it means	Decision support
Hidden risk (high load + low readiness)	Player is loaded heavily but their body isn't recovering. Highest priority for adjustment today.	Drop intensity, monitor closely, consider extra recovery.
Over-loaded (high load + high readiness)	Player is fit and handling load, but is also at the top of the load envelope. Easy to push too far.	Maintain — don't add more on top.
Fresh (low load + high readiness)	Capacity to do more. Load can be added safely.	Available for full session or extra work.
Under-loaded (low load + low readiness)	Player isn't training much AND isn't fresh. Often returning from injury or illness.	Plan a careful ramp-up; investigate why both are low.

Lite tier

Works fully. Both axes — readiness (RPE + wellness) and load (total distance + sRPE × duration) — use universal Catapult metrics that Lite teams have access to.

10. Workflow — your morning briefing on Lite

Step 1 — Open the page (10 seconds)

- Click on the MicroPulse logo or navigate to /coach. The Today tab loads automatically.
- Wait for the cards to fully render — the Daily Briefing computes asynchronously.

Step 2 — Read the Daily Briefing (1 min)

- Top-to-bottom, the briefing tells you the team story for today — who is in Full / Reduced / Recovery, which players changed verdict overnight, and any notable driver-chip flags.
- Toggle to Detailed view if you want the per-player narrative; stick with Compact for the 30-second read.
- If a counterfactual jumps out (e.g. "this player would be GREEN if they slept 8h"), note it — that's a coachable conversation.

Step 3 — Scan the Command Centre (30 seconds)

- Look at the three numerical tiles first: Full, Reduced, Recovery counts. That's your team-state in 5 seconds.
- Read the Coach Recommendation pill — it's the headline action for today.
- If you have a match in 1-3 days, also note the Day state diagnostic and External load summary at the bottom of the pill.

Step 4 — Drill into Decision Summary (3-5 min)

- Scroll to the Decision Summary card — every player in one row.
- For any player with a Reduced or Recovery verdict, click the info button to see the full explanation.
- Cross-check the wellness driver chips against what the player told you in person.
- Note any active injury statuses — those override the load verdict and need separate planning.

Step 5 — Sense-check with the Quadrant (30 seconds)

- Skim the Readiness × Load 2 × 2. Are most of your squad in Fresh or Hidden Risk?
- Hidden Risk cluster = today is a recovery day for the team. Fresh cluster = capacity to push.

Step 6 — Generate a PDF report (optional)

- Click Readiness Risk PDF to print a one-page briefing for the head coach / S&C team.
- After training, click Post-Training PDF to capture how the session went and what to plan for tomorrow.

11. Frequently asked questions

Why are some tabs in the top bar greyed out with a lock icon?

Squad, Load, and GPS tabs require a Pro Catapult subscription. On Lite they show an UpgradeWall when clicked. The functionality those tabs would provide is partially available through dedicated sidebar pages — specifically Load Intelligence and Quadrant View — which work on Lite at full or near-full fidelity.

Why does my Decision Summary show "—" in the decel burden column?

Decel burden is computed from Acceleration & Deceleration B2-3 efforts (Gen 2), a Pro / Premium Catapult parameter that Lite plans don't expose. On Lite, the column will always be "—" — that's expected, not a bug. Use HSR Intelligence (a separate top-tab page) for the Lite-equivalent injury risk read built on Malone 2017 + Buchheit 2014.

Why does the Command Centre show me "—" or "NEUTRAL" for Neural load?

Neural load classification is most precise when fed neuromuscular inputs (jump tests, ForceFrame, NordBord) and autonomic inputs (HRV, RHR). On Lite teams without those integrations the engine still produces a coarse estimate from RPE drift + wellness, but if the available data is too thin it can return NEUTRAL or "—" rather than a confident classification. This is intentional — better to say "unknown" than to fabricate.

How do I tell if today's recommendation is real or just defaulted?

Click the info button on any player row in Decision Summary. The modal shows the full Decision Engine reasoning — including which signals fired, what their thresholds were, and the counterfactual ("this

player would be GREEN if X had been Y"). If the modal shows "insufficient data" you have your answer — the recommendation is conservative, not data-driven.

Where do I see GPS load detail if the GPS tab is locked?

Two places: (1) yesterday's GPS load summary appears inside each Decision Summary row, with total distance, HSR, sprint distance, and NBS. (2) Open Load Intelligence (sidebar → Monitoring → Load Intelligence) for the full per-player external + internal load story. Both are available on Lite.

Why does the Onboarding Checklist not appear for me?

It auto-hides once all 5 setup items are complete. If you want to verify your setup, the same items can be checked individually in Settings → Team and the Integrations page.

12. Limitations — what Today CAN'T do for Lite teams

- Three primary tabs (Squad, Load, GPS) are locked. Squad-overview and per-player load detail must be accessed through dedicated sidebar pages instead.
- Decel burden, A:D Coupling, Residual Decel show "—" in the Decision Summary load-signals block. The Lite-equivalent for injury risk is HSR Intelligence (top-tab).
- Neural load and Dominant fatigue tiles are coarse on Lite without HRV / RHR / jump-test integrations.
- Ask Claude Q&A panel inside the Decision Summary modal is gated behind Elite tier — not available on Lite or Pro.
- The Today page assumes daily RPE and check-in compliance. With sparse compliance the verdicts will be conservative or "—". Push for daily compliance.
- Cards on this page reflect the last 24 hours. For chronic / weekly trends, use Quadrant View (Lite) and HSR Intelligence.

13. References

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